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ANI

INDIGO RETURNS LUGGAGE, REFUNDS CUSTOMERS

Luggage piles up at the airport as IndiGo staff work to deliver delayed and misplaced bags to passengers' addresses after the airline cancelled flights at Indira Gandhi International Airport, in New Delhi yesterday. More than 4,500 bags have been delivered to their owners, with the rest expected within the next 36 hours. IndiGo has also refunded more than Dh41.15 million to customers affected by recent flight cancellations.

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NATION
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for future
of media,
content | P4



IN FOCUS
Red Sea
Film
Festival:
The top
moments
so far | P8-9

Abu Dhabi to invest Dh240b in new infrastructure drive

EMIRATE PLANS TO DOUBLE CAPACITY UNDER URBAN PLAN

ABU DHABI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Abu Dhabi plans to double its population capacity under a new 2040 urban plan, backed by more than Dh240 billion in infrastructure projects aimed at sustaining economic growth and improving quality of life, according to Mohamed Ali Al Shorafa, Chairman of the Department of Municipalities and Transport and Etihad Rail.

Speaking at Abu Dhabi Finance Week 2025, Al Shorafa said the government expects to invest more than Dh240 billion in infrastructure over the next seven to ten years, spanning housing, transportation, health care, and education. "A lot of people think infrastructure is construction. But when you look at infrastructure, it touches a lot of different economic sectors," he said, adding that spending on these assets "generates an economic cycle across hospital-ity, health care, education, construction, and transportation."

Al Shorafa underlined the role of the private sector in this ex-

GLOBAL LEADERS PLEDGE \$1.9B TO END POLIO

International leaders, philanthropists, and global health partners announced yesterday in Abu Dhabi a collective \$1.9 billion to advance polio eradication. This includes approximately \$1.2 billion in newly pledged funds that will reduce the remaining resource gap for the Global Polio Eradication Initiative's (GPEI) 2022-2029 Strategy to \$440 million.

The funds will accelerate vital efforts to reach 370 million children each year with polio vaccines, alongside strengthening health systems in affected countries to protect children from other preventable diseases.

The global pledging event, "Investing in Humanity: Uniting to End Polio", was hosted by the Mohamed Bin Zayed Foundation for Humanity in partnership with GPEI and took place at Abu Dhabi Finance Week.

— WAM

pansion. "This cannot be done only by the government developer. That's why we are involving the private sector in many programmes, because the more infrastructure is there, the more we can generate economic sustainability, growth, and increase our resident exposure to Abu Dhabi."

Beyond physical investments, Abu Dhabi is refining how urban growth affects quality of life. "We developed a new strategy for liveable and lovable," Al Shorafa said. "It's not only the physical assets, but also non-physical aspects and the quality of those as-

sets and how they contribute to nationals and residents."

He pointed to the emirate's "livability programme," launched a year and a half ago with 140 indicators across sectors including education, public spaces, and health care access. "At the beginning of 2026, we are producing our 2.0 programme. It will include 120 different components of quality of services related to our infrastructure, from education to cycling tracks to accessibility to health care and social services."

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